

7.2 Formulas for calculating estimated breeding value based on uniformly related phenotypes

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Figure 7.1 shows the relationship between phenotype measurements of a uniformly related group of individuals, P's, and the breeding value index (I), which is an estimate of the true breeding value (A). Additionally the figure shows the significance of the accuracy (r_{AI}), as the accuracy squared for the index is equal to a reduction of the variance of the estimated breeding value. All values can be interpreted by use of the classical regression equation:

P's = phenotype values of the trait

n = number of measurements

$\bar{P}_g$ = average of a uniformly related group of P's

a' = degree of relationship between the P's and the animal being estimated for the index

a = degree of relationship between P's

$\bar{P}$ = average of the population

$\bar{A}$ = average breeding value of the population = $\bar{P}$

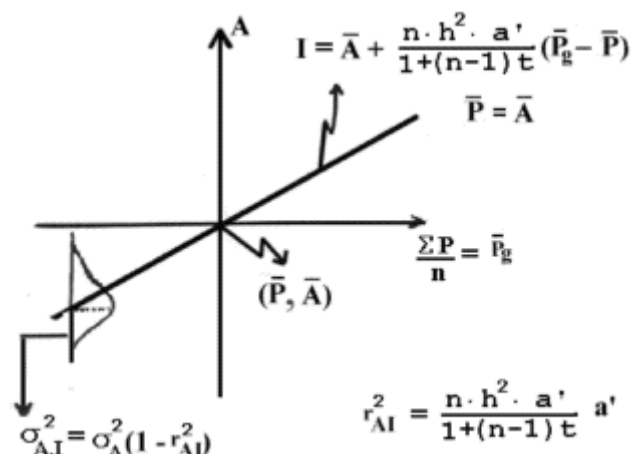
h^2 = heritability

c^2 = common environmental factor for the P's

$t = a \cdot h^2 + c^2$ as defined in section 6.4

Figure 7.1.

Estimation of breeding value indexes based on regression of phenotype measurements (average of a uniformly related group of P's). The definition of the parameters, see above. An example of use of the formulas is given in Figure 7.2.



The estimated breeding value or the index (I) can be calculated by means of the formulas given in Figure 7.1. They can be used in all possible combinations of relationship. It only requires uniform relationships. The index depends on the two coefficients of relationship (a' and a), the number of measurements (n), the heritability (and common environment) and the phenotypical average ($\bar{P}_g$) of the phenotypes. The accuracy (r_{AI}) of the index does not depend on the last factor.

Figure 7.2 gives an example. It is a genealogical diagram with the relevant coefficients of relationship for calculation of an estimated breeding value for milk yields for a bull based on the records of 20 progenies being half sibs (a progeny test). The genealogical diagram is made so that the phenotype measurements, the P's, have an blank circle. For the bull being examined the square is filled in.

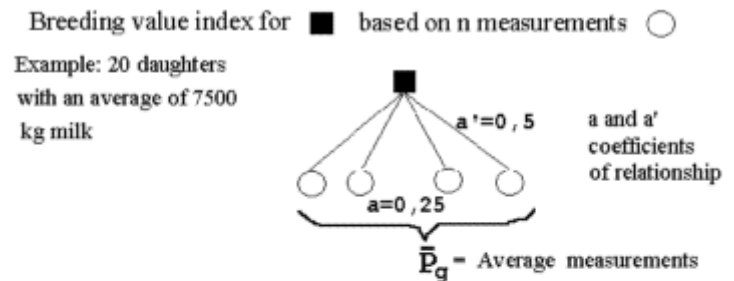
Figure 7.2

shows a diagram of relationship and a calculation of estimated breeding value for milk yield for a bull based on 20 half sib daughters with an average milk yield of 7500 kg.

Below are three additional examples of diagrams of relationship defining the

coefficients of relationship of uniform relationship. Additional diagrams would be superfluous since the parameters are here given for additional examples.

Figure 7.3.



$$h^2 = 0,30, c^2 = 0 \text{ og } \bar{P} = 7000$$

$$I = \bar{A} + \frac{n \cdot h^2 \cdot a'}{1 + (n-1)t} (\bar{P}_g - \bar{P}) = 7000 + \frac{20 \cdot 0,30 \cdot 0,5}{1 + 19 \cdot 0,30 \cdot 0,25} 500 = 7618$$

$$r_{AI}^2 = \frac{n \cdot h^2 \cdot a'}{1 + (n-1)t} a' = \frac{20 \cdot 0,30 \cdot 0,5}{1 + 19 \cdot 0,30 \cdot 0,25} 0,5 = 0,618$$

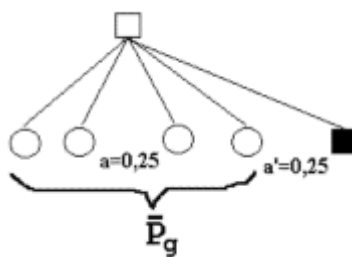


diagram of index based on half sibs.

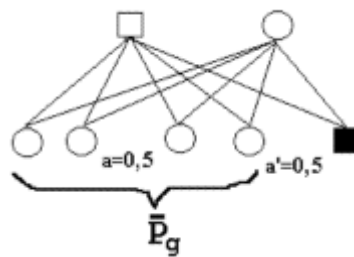


diagram of index based on full sibs. Both parents have the same relationships as a full brother. Therefore, the index is the same for a brother or either of the two parents.

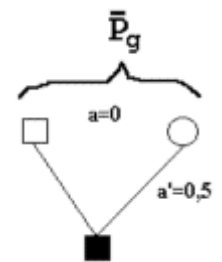


diagram of index based on the parents.

In the table below are given the parameter values of several examples of index calculation in cases concerning uniform relationship conditions. The relevant coefficients of relationships are put into the formula. And when an infinite number of observations are present, the limit value is placed as the regression coefficient and the squared accuracy.

Table Breeding value estimates from uniform measurements of n observations with mean value

$\bar{P}_g$ using the formulas. Infinite is abbreviated inf.

A	$\bar{P}_g$	n	a'	a	t	$I = \bar{A} + \frac{a'nh^2}{1+(n-1)(ah^2+c^2)}(\bar{P}_g - \bar{P})$	$r_{AI}^2 = \frac{a'nh^2 a'}{1+(n-1)(ah^2+c^2)}$
Own	none	0	-	-	-	" + 0	0
"	own	1	1	-	-	" + h^2	" h^2
"	"	2	1	1	h^2+c^2	" + $2h^2/(1+h^2+c^2)$	" $2h^2/(1+h^2+c^2)$
Offspring	both parents	2	.5	0	-	" + h^2	" $.5h^2$
Offspring	grand parents	4	.25	0	-	" + h^2	" $.25h^2$
Father	offspring	1	.5	0	-	" + $.5h^2$	" $.25h^2$
"	"	inf.	.5	.25	$.25h^2+0$	" + 2	" 1
Half brother sib	half	inf.	.25	.25	$.25h^2+0$	" + 1	" $.25$
Full brother sib	full	inf.	.5	.5	$.5h^2+c^2$	" + <1	" $<.5$

The table parameters are defined in relation to Figure 7.1. Any animal, having the same coefficient of relationship, a' , as the measured group, would also have the same estimated breeding value. A full brother,

the father or the mother, for instance, have $a' = .5$ to the same full sib. Or a father, evaluated through an offspring, has the same formula as a son evaluated through the father.

Line 1 in the table corresponds to the formula having 0 measurements, and the index equals the population mean with an accuracy of 0. This presents the 'basis' for evaluation of all the other indexes.

Line 2 in the table correspond to a very common situation. This is normally called a phenotype test. The animal's breeding value is based on measurements of the animal - the equation is:

$$I = A(\text{bar}) + h^2(P - P(\text{bar})) \text{ with a squared accuracy of } h^2.$$

Line 3: Two measurements of the animal, which could be litter size in first and second litter. The correlation between repeated measurements is called **the coefficient of repeatability**. This always contains some common environmental effects for the two measurements.

Line 4 shows the relationship between the average of the parents and the offspring. In section 6.4 this relation was used to estimate the heritability. Therefore it is no surprise to see the same formula again.

Line 7 shows the evaluation of a father based on an infinitely large number of offspring. This corresponds to the definition of breeding value and the weight factor equals 2 and the accuracy squared is equal to 1, this line correspond to the definition of breeding value given in chapter 6.

Accuracy of estimated breeding value

Figure 7.4 shows the accuracy of progeny testing based on n offspring. From the curves it becomes evident that there is larger accuracy at higher heritabilities than at low ones. An increase in the number of offspring can compensate for the low heritability.

Some general remarks should be added about the accuracy of estimated breeding value. By scrutinizing the formula for accuracy it becomes clear that:

1) For traits with high heritabilities the phenotype of the individual is a good source of information.

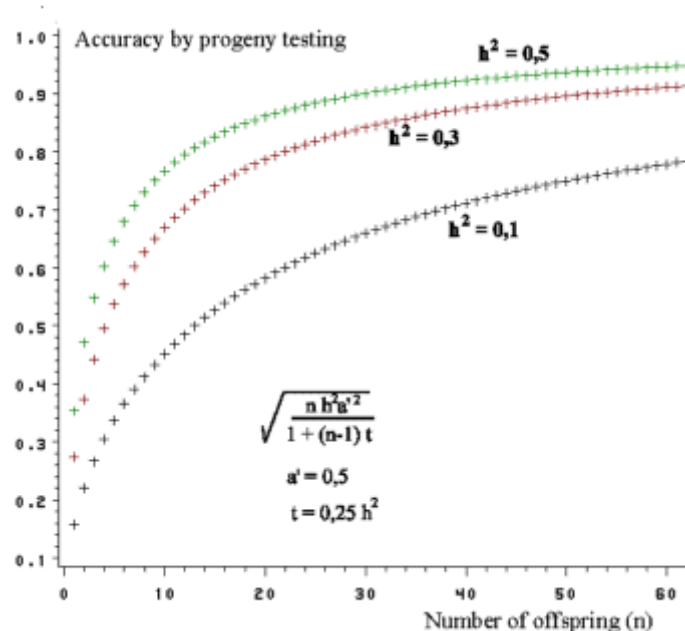
2) For traits with low heritabilities the use of several measurements can compensate for poor accuracy in a single measurement. This is only possible when large groups of offspring of full and half sibs are measured.

Below is a table and the appropriate action to take depending on the magnitude of the heritability

Heritability	Size	Example	Selection
High	Greater than 45%	Fat deposition, milk fat %	Individual
Low	Less than 10%	Reproduction traits	Progeny test
Middle	15-40%	Growth	Mixed

An applet for calculation of the most common cases of estimated breeding value is found [here](#), and an example of the use of it is shown below. From the example it becomes clear that an offspring group of 20 half sibs makes a useful source of information.

Figure 7.4. Accuracy of progeny testing - depending on the number of offspring and the magnitude of the heritability



BV-estimation			Mean value	Heritability %	Common Milieu %	Repeatability %
Calculate			100	25	5	30
Do Nullify BV etc.			Number	Average	Breeding Value (BV)	Accuracy**2 (r**2)
On offspring, full sib			20	110	105.7803	0.2890
On offspring, half sib			20	110	111.4285	0.5714
On own performance			5	110	105.6818	0.5681
On half sibs			100	110	108.6956	0.2173
On both parents			2	110	102.5000	0.1250
a' og a	.5	1.	2	110	101.9230	0.0961

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